

Texas Education Career Routes

NAME _____

DATE _____

PERIOD _____

Keep the Routes Accurate

For most Texas classroom-teacher certificates, the current TEA route includes five requirements: an accredited bachelor's degree, an approved educator preparation program, the appropriate certification exams, a state application, and fingerprinting/background review. Some Career and Technical Education certificates have different degree and work-experience rules.

An educator preparation program may be university-based, post-baccalaureate, or an approved alternative-certification program. Program admission, clinical teaching, internships, residencies, cost, aid, and timing vary. Do not label one route automatically cheaper, faster, paid, or better without provider evidence.

Source checked: Texas Education Agency, Becoming a Classroom Teacher in Texas, current August 2026.

Write the five common requirements in your own words:

One claim I will not make without provider evidence:

Route A — University-Based Preparation

Possible pattern: complete a bachelor's degree and approved educator preparation through a college or university, including required clinical experience, then meet testing, application, and fingerprinting requirements.

What is verified across Texas:

What varies by university or program:

One question a student should ask a provider:

Route B — Post-Baccalaureate or Alternative Certification

Possible pattern: first hold an accredited bachelor's degree, then enter an approved educator preparation program. Internship, residency, clinical teaching, tuition, aid, testing, and employment rules vary by provider and certificate area.

What is verified across Texas:

What varies by provider:

One question a student should ask a provider:

Educational Aide I Boundary

TEA says the high-school Educational Aide I certificate has specific course, grade, credit, age, district-verification, application, and background-review conditions. A pathway name alone does not guarantee that a student receives the certificate.

Current Irving public evidence names **Education and Training** at Irving High, MacArthur, and Nimitz, and **Early Childhood Education** at Cardwell. The public page does not by itself promise a particular course schedule, certificate, placement, transportation, or admission.

Two facts a student must verify before planning around Educational Aide I:

One question for a counselor or CTE coordinator:

Compare and Decide

DECISION FACTOR	UNIVERSITY-BASED ROUTE	POST-BACCALAUREATE OR ALTERNATIVE ROUTE
Degree timing		
Educator preparation		
Clinical experience		
Facts that vary		

The better route for this fictional student and why:

Jordan wants to teach high-school mathematics. Jordan is comparing one university-based program and one approved program completed after a mathematics degree. What exact provider evidence must Jordan compare before deciding?